
Applied Economics: Seminars

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Seminars

Applied Economics (ECON1065) split into two parts:

- International, Trade, Integration
- Growth, Development, Institutions

Assessment:

- **Group Presentation, 25 percent**
- Open Book 1 hour exam, 75 percent
 - 6 sides A4 typed or written
 - No calculator allowed

Seminars are for preparing your slides and then presenting your work

This week is about forming groups and getting the process started!

Seminars

Schedule: Weeks 2, 4, 6 are prep / 9, 11 presentations Check, room and time might change

Office hours in 20m slots with me:

- Office B37 in Clive Granger Building
- Thursdays and Fridays, slots 1400-1800
- Use MS Bookings tool (can email link)

The Presentation

Groups will present in weeks 9 and 11

- 8 minutes presenting, 2 minutes questions and discussion
- I recommend max. 4 slides with text (ignoring graphs)
- Max 3 students per group
- Up to you to split tasks
- Everyone in the group gets the same mark
- Seminars are designed to guide topic selection and preparation

Topics (1/3)

Choose **one** topic for your group presentation. I know it is only week 1, so it is fine if you are still unsure.

Topic 1: Trade Creation and Customs Union

- (a) Why is it important for a customs union to be predominantly trade-creating rather than trade-diverting?
- (b) To what extent has the EU customs union generated the expected gains in trade, despite widespread fears in 1958 of job losses and factory closures?

Topic 2: The Common Market for Labour

- (a) What is the economic argument for a common market for labour?
- (b) Why is an integrated labour market in the EU hard to achieve?
- (c) How has Brexit, particularly the end of free movement, affected labour markets, output and welfare in the UK and Eastern European EU member states?

Topics (2/3)

Topic 3: Regional Trade Agreements and the WTO

Does the proliferation of regional trade agreements (RTAs) undermine or support the WTO's multilateral system?

Topic 4: The Impacts of Free Trade Areas (FTAs)

- (a) What were the economic impacts of NAFTA on the United States, Canada and Mexico?
- (b) In light of President Trump's renewed tariffs on Canadian goods and his criticism of USMCA, what are the likely economic consequences for the United States and Canada?

Topic 5: Optimum Currency Areas and the Eurozone

- (a) What are Mundell's main criteria for an optimum currency area, particularly labour mobility and wage flexibility?
- (b) To what extent does the Eurozone satisfy these criteria? Support your assessment with evidence from recent European crises, such as the Eurozone sovereign-debt crisis and the energy-price shock.

Your job now

So between now and the same session in two weeks:

1. organise yourselves as a group, decide on the topic
2. sketch main ideas, centred on:
 - **The facts** (data: FRED, OECD, WTO)
 - **Mechanisms** (theory/model predictions)
 - Take a stand on **main answer**
 - Edge cases, exceptions, interesting cases, heterogeneity
3. Keep in mind the assessment criteria:
 - Economic content, relevance and accuracy
 - Independent research beyond the lectures
 - Quality and clarity of the slides
 - ... of Oral presentation
 - ... of answers in questions and discussion